



MONTHLY UPDATE

Seychelles: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-25 · 24 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Summary of the month

Twenty-two rows fall in the window from 1 July to 19 August 2026. The National Assembly approved accession to the Budapest Convention on Cybercrime; Airtel switched on commercial 5G and Starlink began commercial service; and Cabinet approved a National AI in Education Framework, a Foreign Exchange Act amendment, UNOOSA accession and Multidimensional Vulnerability Index measures in a single 22 July sitting. India's NPCI signed a UPI memorandum during Prime Minister Modi's visit, and the Seychelles Revenue Commission advanced e-invoicing procurement to its final stage. In August the record turned to institutions and to what the public makes of them: the National Institute for Science, Technology and Innovation was described as reinstated under the Office of the Vice-President, and an Afrobarometer survey found perceived media freedom down six points since 2022, two months after Parliament moved appointment power over the public broadcaster's board to the President.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

Cabinet approved measures to operationalise the Multidimensional Vulnerability Index on 22 July 2026, naming "enhanced data and institutional capacity" and alignment of planning and budgeting frameworks as the instruments, with no implementation detail yet given. [President Herminie restated a "fully digitalised e-government by 2030" target on 4 August](#), while receiving Malta's first High Commissioner's credentials and naming bilateral technical cooperation as the route under discussion. On 10 August the institution meant to carry that work was described as back in place: [the National Institute for Science, Technology and Innovation has been reinstated, its Secretariat sitting under the Office of the Vice-President](#) after five years in which it was closed and its functions folded into a ministry division. Its Secretary of State puts its near-term focus on technological innovation in government procedures and on accelerating the digitalisation of public-service delivery. No commencement notice for the NISTI Act 2025 is on record, so the body is described as functioning without the statute behind it being shown to be in force.

Regional collaboration

[AUDA-NEPAD launched its Programme for African Developing Island Economies at the AU's STC Ministerial Segment in Abidjan on 24 July 2026](#), adopting a ministerial communique covering seven island states including Seychelles on a 2026–2031 roadmap that names digital transformation one of six pillars, alongside partners Korea, AfDB, the regional economic communities and the Indian Ocean Commission.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Parliament amended the [Seychelles Broadcasting Corporation Act in June 2026](#), transferring greater power over the appointment and dismissal of the public broadcaster's board from the independent Constitutional Appointments Authority to the President. The base holds no primary text of the amendment; what it holds is Afrobarometer's August dispatch, which reports it citing Broadcast Media Africa and the International Press Institute, and sets it against the survey it was publishing.

That survey, fielded in 2025, finds [45% of Seychellois calling the media somewhat or completely free, down from 51% in 2022, with 52% saying it is not very or not at all free](#) — a decline recorded on a media environment that Reporters Without Borders ranked 35th globally in 2026, up ten places. Appetite for oversight is not in doubt: [78% want the media to investigate government mistakes and corruption constantly, and 85% back the right to publish without government interference](#).

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

Mauritius Telecom CEO Veemal Gungadin announced a [cross-border payments partnership between Mauritius and Seychelles fintech Eboo on 16 July 2026](#), at the AllMyT Summit, as the first of a planned series of Indian Ocean regional payment announcements. No operational detail, launch date or terms were given.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

[Airtel Seychelles switched on commercial 5G on 3 July 2026](#), pairing the launch with a content partnership with SBC. [Starlink's soft launch followed on 21 July](#), reported by State House the next day, with several subscribers already active; the wider African rollout that included Seychelles [reached 28 of 54 African markets by 28 July](#).

Cybersecurity

The [National Assembly voted unanimously on 22 July 2026 to approve accession to the Budapest Convention on Cybercrime](#), a motion tabled by Hon. Sylvanne Lemiel. The accession itself, an executive act, has not yet followed.

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech

[NPCI International and the Central Bank of Seychelles signed a UPI memorandum during Prime Minister Modi's visit on 29 June 2026](#), targeting a rollout by the end of the year. Acting Commissioner General Fred Morel confirmed the [Revenue Commission's mandatory e-invoicing procurement had reached its final stage by 23 July](#), following an Expression of Interest opened in March. Cabinet approved amendments to the Foreign Exchange Act 2009 on 22 July, widening the "authorised dealer" definition to credit unions and licensed payment service providers.

Sectoral management information systems

[Firstpost reported on 8 August 2026](#) that bilateral consultations between India and Seychelles on adopting the e-Sanjeevani, e-Office and e-Hospital platforms were advancing, with no MoU, pilot or date yet established.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Vice-President Ahmed Afif [announced an eight-week automated traffic-enforcement pilot for Roche Caiman, Mahe, on 30 July](#), repurposing the public CCTV estate with the Australian firm Acusensus; no data-protection basis for the processing was stated. Permanent adoption depends on the pilot's outcome.

Technology

AI

[Cabinet approved a National AI in Education Framework 2026-2030 on 22 July 2026](#), reported by State House on 31 July: a 21-page policy covering every state school, integrating AI literacy across the curriculum, requiring a mandatory AI micro-credential for teachers, naming an AI Champion per school and establishing a Steering Committee to maintain approved and prohibited AI-tool lists. Two World Bank pilots – an AI Teacher Coach for Primary 5–6 teachers and an AI Student Tutor for Secondary 3 Maths and Geography – were already running ahead of the Framework's approval. Neither the Framework's own text nor a budget or implementation timeline has been published; a first automated acquisition attempt on 9 August failed to locate the document.

Capacity

Training and skills

The AI Teacher Coach and AI Student Tutor pilots that feed into the AI in Education Framework were both reported already running when State House described the Framework on 31 July 2026 – the Teacher Coach across six schools, the Student Tutor across four – with no exact start dates given for either.

Inclusion

Access to services

The same survey puts a number on demand for open government, which the Access to Information Act reform has been drafted against since November 2025 without a Bill reaching Parliament. [62% say the public should have access to government information, against 25% who say it is for officials only](#); support is strongest where the information is fiscal – [84% for district-administration budgets and 82% for bids and contracts on government projects](#) – and falls to 47% for the salaries of district administrators and teachers.

Data

National statistics

The statistical work of the window is climate data with a funding line behind it. Seychelles [launched its national implementation of a nine-country African island-states resilience programme, backed by a US\\$4.943 million readiness grant, whose data leg is a standardised approach to institutional readiness, multi-hazard risk assessment and information systems](#), the stated purpose being to build pipelines of climate-resilient projects able to reach international finance. The grant figure covers all nine countries; the national share is not published, so the base can date the launch and not size it.

Use of satellite data

Cabinet approved accession to the UN Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space and engagement with UNOOSA on 22 July 2026, framed as building geospatial-data capability for maritime security, disaster preparedness and ocean management; no accession process or programme detail has followed.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-25
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SYC/SYC-monthly.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/SYC/SYC-monthly-2026-08-25.pdf
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